

Social Media Automation — Tester Guide

Drop your content here: the shared Google Drive inbox folder link on the hub page.

One message. Four platforms. Zero manual effort.

This tool turns a plain text file into ready-to-publish, platform-optimized social posts — with AI-generated visuals — automatically. As a tester, you don't need any accounts or setup: just drop a correctly-formatted `.txt` file into the shared inbox folder and the automation takes it from there.

- Drop a `.txt` file → posts go live on 4 platforms (Instagram, Facebook, BlueSky, X)
- Claude AI generates platform-optimized captions for each one
- Blotato creates branded visual infographics automatically
- Google Drive manages input, config, completed & error files
- 8 visual templates — chalkboard, newspaper, billboard, and more
- Scheduled posts supported — set a future date/time per file
- Up to 5 files processed per run, with error handling built in
- Full audit trail logged to Google Sheets after every post

How it works — main components

Claude AI — reads the brand voice + your source text and generates 4 platform-optimized captions (X, Instagram, Facebook, BlueSky) in one pass. Enforces fact accuracy — it never invents statistics; it only uses what's in your source text.

Blotato — posts to all 4 platforms via one API call, and generates the branded visual infographic (chalkboard, newspaper, billboard, etc.) before posting.

Google Drive — four folders: `inbox/` (drop files here), `config/` (brand voice + settings), `completed/` (processed files), `error/` (failed files). The workflow polls the inbox every 30 minutes.

Google Sheets — an automatic audit log after every post. The success log captures platform, post ID, text, and image URL; the error log captures the failure reason for diagnosis.

Writing a content file

Create a `.txt` file with this format:

```
TEMPLATE: chalkboard
SCHEDULE: 2026-05-22 19:00
```

```
NEWSPAPER_NAME: YOUR PUBLICATION NAME
X_IMAGE: false
BLUESKY_IMAGE: false
[
Your content here...
Multiple lines supported.
Source: Your source name and URL
```

Metadata lines (all optional except TEMPLATE):

Line	Values	Description
TEMPLATE :	see below	Required. Template key or none
NEWSPAPER_NAME :	any text	Newspaper template only — suggested masthead name
SCHEDULE :	YYYY-MM-DD HH:MM	Eastern Time, 24-hour. Omit to post immediately
X_IMAGE :	true / false	Override X image setting
BLUESKY_IMAGE :	true / false	Override BlueSky image setting

Available templates:

Key	Description
quote_card	Quote card carousel
chalkboard	Chalkboard infographic
newspaper	Newspaper front-page style
instagram_carousel	Instagram carousel
quote_carousel	Quote carousel
tutorial_carousel	Tutorial/how-to carousel
breaking_news	Breaking news style
billboard	Billboard infographic

none

Static image (requires a matching .jpg with the same file name in the inbox)

A worked example — "the only thing you write"

Input file: chalkboard-immediate.txt

```
TEMPLATE: chalkboard
|
Key Gun Violence Facts in America:
45,000+ Americans die from gun violence every year
States with stronger gun laws have 40% fewer gun deaths.
90% of Americans support universal background checks.
Every $1 invested in prevention saves $10 in costs.
Source: Everytown for Gun Safety 2024
Source: CDC National Center for Health Statistics 2024
```

What the system does with it:

1. Detects `TEMPLATE: chalkboard` → routes to visual generation.
2. No `SCHEDULE` line → posts immediately.
3. Blotato generates a chalkboard infographic from the facts (takes 1-10 minutes).
4. Claude AI writes 4 captions: a punchy X post, Instagram with hashtags, a longer Facebook post, and a short BlueSky post.
5. Posts to all 4 platforms simultaneously.
6. The file moves to `completed/` — success is logged to Google Sheets.

That's the whole loop — write facts and sources, pick a template, drop the file.

Running it & what to monitor

Steps: 1. Write your .txt file — `TEMPLATE:` line first, then your facts and sources. 2. Drop the file into the shared Google Drive **inbox** folder. 3. Wait up to 30 minutes for the automatic scan to pick it up (or ask the owner to trigger it manually). 4. Visual generation takes 1-10 minutes once picked up; all 4 platform posts fire once the visual is ready. 5. Check the Drive **completed/** folder — your file appears there once fully processed. That's your confirmation.

Where to check status:

Where

What it tells you

Google Drive <code>completed/</code>	Your file moved here → fully processed
Google Drive <code>error/</code>	Your file landed here → something failed (e.g. visual generation)
Google Sheets Success Log	4 rows added per file (one per platform), with post IDs
Google Sheets Error Log	Shows the failure reason if a file went to <code>error/</code>
Published posts	The live posts themselves, on each connected platform

If a file sits in the inbox for a long time without moving, or you don't see the expected posts, let the owner know — it may need a manual trigger, or there may be a configuration issue on the automation side (this is normal for a tool still being adapted for campaign use).

A note on where this tool is headed

This automation currently requires the owner to configure accounts, API keys, and posting credentials centrally — testers only ever interact with the Drive inbox folder, never with the automation's internal setup. As it's adapted specifically for political campaign use, a more self-serve interface may replace this Drive-drop workflow.

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